There are entire books (such as the excellent *Programming Ecto [WM19]*) written about Ecto, so there's no way we can cover everything in a single chapter. Instead, this chapter gives you the basics and points you to the Ecto documentation[1] to learn more.

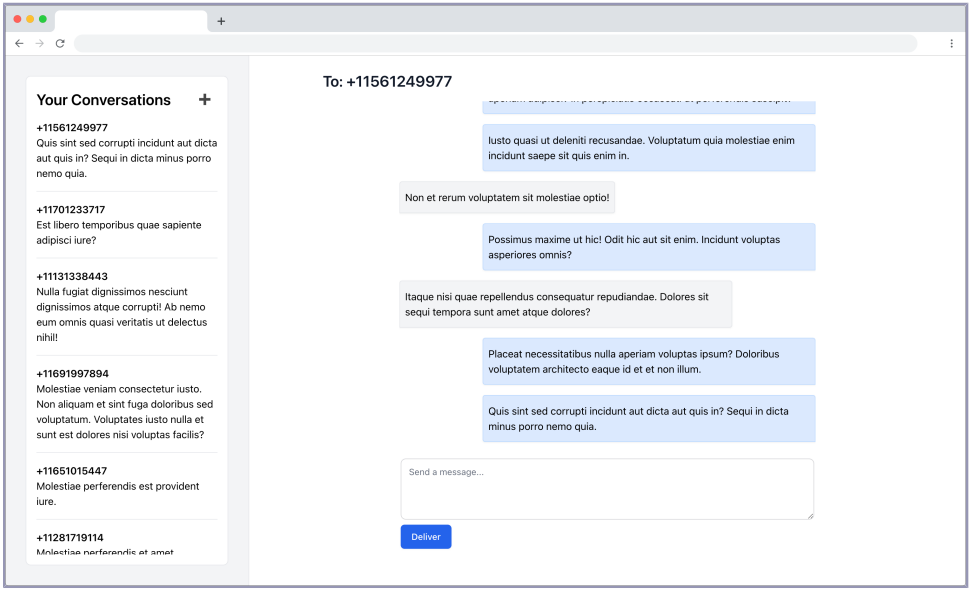
Let's look at the project that we'll be writing during Part II.

What Will We Build?

I love building web applications that interact with the real world in some way. One of the "secret tricks" that has served me well over my career is the use of SMS and Phone to connect applications to users. So, our project is an SMS client that sends and receives SMS using a mock SMS API.

This project is compatible with a real SMS provider—Twilio—and is capable of sending and receiving real SMS messages. However, regulation was passed that requires verification to deliver SMS messages in the USA. Instead, we'll use a mock SMS API that's 100% compatible with Twilio—you could take the project at the end of the book and connect it to a real Twilio account!

Here's what the final product will look like. We'll have a list of SMS conversations on the left and a detailed view of the current conversation on the right:



1. https://hexdocs.pm/ecto/Ecto.html